

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 225

By McNally

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor William "Bill" Clabough, Sr., for his contributions to the Foothills Land Conservancy.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is William "Bill" Clabough, Sr., whose leadership and tireless efforts in support of the Foothills Land Conservancy can only be categorized as outstanding; and

WHEREAS, through the tremendous investment and leadership of Bill Clabough over the last twenty years, the Foothills Land Conservancy (FLC) has assisted in the land preservation of more than 200,000 acres that include 500 conservation projects in Tennessee and six surrounding states; and

WHEREAS, FLC endeavors to protect, preserve, and enhance the lands and environment of the Southern Appalachian region and also to promote the character of the land for the benefit of the general public, now and in the future; in 2025, FLC will be celebrating its fortieth year of service as a regional land trust; and

WHEREAS, a Blount Countian through and through, Mr. Clabough was born in Maryville and graduated from the Blount County School system and the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, where he received a Bachelor of Science degree in Business Administration; he spent more than thirty years in the retail grocery business before serving as an elected representative in both the Tennessee House of Representatives and Senate; and

WHEREAS, Bill Clabough became FLC's executive director in March 2006; his passion lies in moving FLC forward on land protection partnerships, land stewardship, and community outreach, and he is a hands-on leader for all the projects and initiatives the organization manages; and

WHEREAS, within the State of Tennessee, and almost exclusively during Mr. Clabough's tenure, FLC's land conservation projects grew to span fifty-two counties and over 250 landowner partnerships, with more than 100,000 acres preserved in total; and

WHEREAS, he has also assisted in the permanent conservation of Blount County's beloved Camp Montvale, seven Tennessee Century Farms, Jarvis Park in Blount County, an additional 1,000 acres of land transferred to the Mount Roosevelt State Wildlife Management Area in Roane County, and 649 acres of land in Polk County, which was transferred to the Tennessee Wildlife Resources Agency; and

WHEREAS, in recent years, Bill Clabough has worked with FLC's board and staff to create a permanent foundation for planned gifts that includes land acquisition and stewardship programs, the Land Preservation Fund, and other conservation-related projects; and

WHEREAS, in 2010, FLC completed the 25 in 25 Initiative, a campaign created and launched by Mr. Clabough in October 2007; the public awareness campaign set an organizational goal to preserve a total of 25,000 East Tennessee acres by 2010 to mark the twenty-fifth anniversary of FLC; and

WHEREAS, at the time, FLC had 17,000 acres protected through land donations and conservation easements but wanted to engage the community in the coming years and bring awareness of its mission of land conservation to East Tennessee residents and families; through the efforts of FLC's staff and board, local media coverage, and partnerships with the Little River Watershed Association and Legacy Parks Foundation, FLC was able to accomplish its preservation goal in December 2009; and

WHEREAS, Bill Clabough was a dynamic participant in the legislative process during his time in the General Assembly, earning the respect and admiration of his colleagues for his outstanding contributions as vice chairman of the Commerce, Labor and Agriculture Committee and as secretary of the Finance, Ways and Means Committee; and

WHEREAS, he also served with distinction as treasurer of the Senate Republican Caucus during the 101st General Assembly and was elected Chairman of the Senate Republican Caucus during the 102nd General Assembly; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Clabough was duly honored as Legislator of the Year by the Tennessee Firemen's Association, and he has ably served the citizens of Blount County as a board chairman of CBBC Bank, former board member of the Great Smoky Mountains Park Commission, and member of the Blount County Commission, Blount Memorial Hospital, and the Boys and Girls Club of Blount County; he is also a former member of the Blount County Families First Council and a participant in Leadership Blount and Leadership Sevier County; and

WHEREAS, Bill Clabough also served his community as a member of Kiwanis, Farm Bureau, Trout Unlimited, and the Blount County, Sevierville, and Gatlinburg chambers of commerce; he has also served as a volunteer with the Great Smoky Mountains National Park and Appalachian Trails Conservancy; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Clabough, along with the leadership, board, and staff of FLC, works diligently to protect, preserve, and enhance the lands and environment of the Southern Appalachian region, and he is most worthy of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor William "Bill" Clabough, Sr.,

for his many contributions to the Foothills Land Conservancy and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.